Case Study: UPI/Online Payment Fraud

UPI fraud is a common cybercrime in India where attackers trick users into transferring money through fake payment requests or links. It mainly targets students, working professionals, and people who frequently use digital payment apps.

In a typical case, a fraudster contacts the victim through a phone call, SMS, or social media message pretending to be a bank official or a buyer/seller. The attacker sends a fake payment link or requests the victim to scan a QR code. The victim is often told that they will receive money, but instead, money gets deducted from their account after entering their UPI PIN.

The step-by-step process usually involves gaining the victim’s trust, creating urgency, and guiding them to perform actions without thinking. Many victims fall for such scams due to lack of awareness or panic.

The consequences of UPI fraud include financial loss, stress, and sometimes identity theft if personal details are shared. In severe cases, victims may lose their entire savings.

This case highlights the importance of digital literacy and awareness. Users must understand that receiving money never requires entering a PIN and should always verify before making any transaction.

Source: National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) – UPI Safety Guidelines, and various reported UPI fraud cases on OLX platforms in India.